

THE UGC HOOK BANK

# 100+ UGC HOOKS

*128 proven spoken and visual hooks for product, website, and app videos. Fill in the blank, film, post.*

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BEFORE YOU FILM

# WHAT IS A HOOK?

*A hook is the first few seconds of your video. Its only job is to stop the scroll.*

## THE RULE

## WHY IT MATTERS

|     |                           |                                                                                                                                   |
|-----|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01. | <b>Fill every blank</b>   | Swap each [bracket] for something specific. Real numbers, real timeframes, real product details.                                  |
| 02. | <b>Say it up front</b>    | The hook is the first line. Say it out loud and put it on screen as text, too.                                                    |
| 03. | <b>Match the visual</b>   | Give them something to watch while you talk. Start mid-action: setting your phone down, setting the product out, opening the app. |
| 04. | <b>Pay it off</b>         | Whatever the hook promises, the video has to deliver. Otherwise viewers swipe and stop trusting you.                              |
| 05. | <b>Test more than one</b> | Film two or three hooks for the same video.                                                                                       |

FILL IN THE BLANK, WORD FOR WORD

*"I tried [product] for [time]. Here's what happened."*

*becomes "I tried this meal delivery service for a week. Here's what happened."*

*Brackets are placeholders. The more specific you make them, the better the hook performs.*

HOOKS FOR

# VISUAL HOOKS

*What viewers see in the first second matters as much as what they hear. Pair any spoken hook below with one of these.*

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## THE VISUAL + HOW TO FILM IT

- |                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>01. Setting down your phone</b><br>Start the video as you set the phone down. It feels like you just hit record on something real. | <b>02. Stirring your drink</b><br>Stir an iced coffee or matcha while you say your first line.                        |
| <b>03. Pouring into your drink</b><br>Pour in milk, creamer or a drink mix. The swirl is satisfying to watch.                         | <b>04. Cutting fruit</b><br>Slice fruit or prep food while you talk. Busy hands keep eyes on screen.                  |
| <b>05. Food in front of you</b><br>Start with a plate in frame or mid-bite.                                                           | <b>06. Opening or closing your laptop</b><br>Open the lid to reveal the screen. Perfect for apps and websites.        |
| <b>07. Fidget toys</b><br>Squish slime or spin a fidget spinner. Oddly satisfying motion stops the thumb.                             | <b>08. Microphone or AirPods</b><br>Talk into a mini mic or pop an AirPods in. Reads like a podcast or a real update. |
| <b>09. Eye-catching elements</b><br>A bright color, bold outfit or unexpected object in frame.                                        | <b>10. Long shot, slow zoom</b><br>Film wide, then slowly zoom in on you. Builds anticipation.                        |
| <b>11. Multitasking</b><br>Talk while doing something else: makeup, folding laundry, packing a bag.                                   | <b>12. Prop or visual</b><br>Hold up the product, a screenshot or a receipt. Show what you're talking about.          |
| <b>13. Whiteboard</b><br>Write on or point to a whiteboard. Instantly says "I'm teaching you something."                              | <b>14. Mirror</b><br>Film in or through a mirror. Natural for beauty, fashion and fitness.                            |
| <b>15. Walking in or out of frame</b><br>Walk into the shot, or start walking away from the camera.                                   | <b>16. Catching something</b><br>Catch the product, or something tossed to you, as the video starts.                  |
| <b>17. Sitting down or standing up</b><br>Sit down or stand up as you start talking to the camera. The movement pulls viewers in.     |                                                                                                                       |
- 

*Start mid-action. Never start still.*

HOOKS FOR

# CURIOSITY

*Open a gap the viewer needs closed. They stay to get the answer.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|     |                                                                                        |                                                                                |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 18. | What no one tells you about <i>[product]</i> ...                                       | What no one tells you about switching to a budgeting app...                    |
| 19. | The surprising truth about <i>[product category]</i> ...                               | The surprising truth about natural deodorant...                                |
| 20. | Things I wish I knew before buying <i>[product]</i> ...                                | Things I wish I knew before buying a standing desk.                            |
| 21. | I was today years old when I found out <i>[product]</i> could <i>[feature]</i> .       | I was today years old when I found out my notes app could transcribe meetings. |
| 22. | If you think <i>[product]</i> is just for <i>[common use]</i> , think again.           | If you think a rice cooker is just for rice, think again.                      |
| 23. | The real reason everyone's obsessed with <i>[product]</i> ...                          | The real reason everyone's obsessed with this water bottle...                  |
| 24. | Watch what happens after <i>[time]</i> of using <i>[product]</i> . Wait until the end. | Watch my skin after 30 days of this serum. Wait until the end.                 |
| 25. | Ever wondered what would happen if you used <i>[product]</i> for <i>[time]</i> ?       | Ever wondered what would happen if you used a sunrise alarm for a month?       |
| 26. | Nobody's talking about <i>[product]</i> , and I don't get why.                         | Nobody's talking about this budgeting app, and I don't get why.                |
| 27. | You won't see this anywhere else about <i>[product]</i> ...                            | You won't see this anywhere else about the real benefits of probiotics...      |

*Tease the answer. Never give it away in the first line.*

HOOKS FOR

# MISTAKES & WARNINGS

*Nobody wants to be doing it wrong. Name the mistake and they'll stay to check.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|     |                                                                                   |                                                                       |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 28. | Don't make this mistake with <i>[product]</i> .                                   | Don't make this mistake with your first air fryer.                    |
| 29. | The one mistake that's costing you <i>[money/time]</i> on <i>[category]</i> ...   | The one mistake that's costing you hundreds on skincare...            |
| 30. | If you're doing this with <i>[product]</i> , you're wasting <i>[money/time]</i> . | If you're doing this with your meal kit, you're wasting money.        |
| 31. | Most people are using <i>[product]</i> wrong.                                     | Most people are using their makeup brushes wrong.                     |
| 32. | I've been using <i>[product]</i> wrong my whole life.                             | I've been using my hair straightener wrong my whole life.             |
| 33. | If you do this with <i>[product]</i> , stop immediately.                          | If you're still saving passwords in your notes app, stop immediately. |
| 34. | 3 things to avoid if you want <i>[result]</i> .                                   | 3 things to avoid if you want your nails to last two weeks.           |
| 35. | Don't spend another dollar on <i>[product type]</i> until you see this.           | Don't spend another dollar on face cream until you see this.          |
| 36. | The #1 mistake people make with <i>[activity]</i> .                               | The #1 mistake people make with shaving.                              |

*Make the mistake specific enough that the viewer wonders if it's them.*

HOOKS FOR

# MYTHS & BOLD CLAIMS

*Take a side. A confident opinion stops the scroll faster than a neutral one.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|     |                                                                                            |                                                                                           |
|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 37. | <b>The internet convinced us <i>[belief]</i>, but I'm here to tell you <i>[truth]</i>.</b> | The internet convinced us protein powder tastes bad, but I'm here to tell you it doesn't. |
| 38. | <b>Here's why I changed my mind about <i>[product/belief]</i>.</b>                         | Here's why I changed my mind about meal delivery apps.                                    |
| 39. | <b>Why you should stop listening to <i>[common advice]</i> about <i>[category]</i>.</b>    | Why you should stop listening to the advice to skip toner.                                |
| 40. | <b>Hottest take of the year: <i>[opinion about category]</i>.</b>                          | Hottest take of the year: you don't need a 10-step skincare routine.                      |
| 41. | <b>Whoever said <i>[claim]</i> clearly never tried <i>[product]</i>.</b>                   | Whoever said budgeting is boring clearly never tried this app.                            |
| 42. | <b>This might ruin <i>[old product]</i> for you, but <i>[new product]</i>...</b>           | This might ruin regular pillowcases for you, but silk...                                  |
| 43. | <b>You say you have the best <i>[product]</i>, but is it missing <i>[feature]</i>?</b>     | You say you have the best planner app, but does it sync with your calendar?               |
| 44. | <b>Show me a better <i>[product]</i>. I'll wait.</b>                                       | Show me a better travel steamer. I'll wait.                                               |
| 45. | <b>This is a hill I'm willing to die on: <i>[product claim]</i>.</b>                       | This is a hill I'm willing to die on: this is the only mascara that doesn't smudge.       |
| 46. | <b>We've been doing <i>[task]</i> wrong this whole time.</b>                               | We've been loading the dishwasher wrong this whole time.                                  |

*Commit to the claim. Then let the product back it up.*

HOOKS FOR

# RESULTS & TRANSFORMATION

*Show the before and promise the after. The viewer stays to see how you got there.*

| THE HOOK |                                                                                    | EXAMPLE                                                                 |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 47.      | Here's how I went from <i>[problem]</i> to <i>[result]</i> with <i>[product]</i> . | Here's how I went from acne-prone to clear skin with this routine.      |
| 48.      | How I got <i>[result]</i> in just <i>[time frame]</i> .                            | How I got better sleep in just one week with this pillow.               |
| 49.      | <i>[#]</i> things I learned after <i>[#]</i> weeks of using <i>[product]</i> .     | 5 things I learned after 3 weeks of using this language app.            |
| 50.      | This small change had a huge impact on my <i>[result]</i> .                        | This small change to my morning coffee had a huge impact on my energy.  |
| 51.      | How I <i>[achieved result]</i> without <i>[typical requirement]</i> .              | How I cleared my skin without expensive treatments.                     |
| 52.      | Here's what finally worked after years of trying to <i>[goal]</i> .                | Here's what finally worked after years of trying to stick to a budget.  |
| 53.      | The fastest way to get <i>[result]</i> with <i>[product]</i> .                     | The fastest way to get salon-quality hair at home.                      |
| 54.      | This was my biggest wake-up call about <i>[problem]</i> .                          | This was my biggest wake-up call about how much I spend on takeout.     |
| 55.      | The most powerful thing I learned after <i>[time]</i> with <i>[product]</i> .      | The most powerful thing I learned after 6 months with this fitness app. |
| 56.      | Here's what <i>[time]</i> of using <i>[product]</i> actually looks like.           | Here's what 30 days of using this language app actually looks like.     |

*Specific numbers and timeframes make results believable.*

HOOKS FOR

# HONEST REVIEW

*Sound like a real person testing it, not an ad. Skepticism builds trust.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|     |                                                                       |                                                                        |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 57. | I tried <i>[product]</i> for <i>[time]</i> . Here's what happened.    | I tried this meal delivery service for a week. Here's what happened.   |
| 58. | I didn't believe it until I tried <i>[product]</i> myself.            | I didn't believe it until I tried this vegan protein myself.           |
| 59. | I tried to talk myself out of buying <i>[product]</i> , but...        | I tried to talk myself out of buying this robot vacuum, but...         |
| 60. | I'm lowkey embarrassed it took me this long to try <i>[product]</i> . | I'm lowkey embarrassed it took me this long to try a password manager. |
| 61. | My biggest regret is not trying <i>[product]</i> sooner.              | My biggest regret is not buying a good blender sooner.                 |
| 62. | What I discovered after trying <i>[product]</i> ...                   | What I discovered after trying this plant-based protein...             |
| 63. | Is <i>[product]</i> actually worth it? Let's find out.                | Is this \$40 water bottle actually worth it? Let's find out.           |
| 64. | I bought the viral <i>[product]</i> so you don't have to.             | I bought the viral heatless curler so you don't have to.               |
| 65. | Here goes nothing: first time trying <i>[product]</i> .               | Here goes nothing: first time trying a robot vacuum.                   |
| 66. | I didn't expect <i>[product]</i> to <i>[surprising result]</i> .      | I didn't expect a pillow to fix my neck pain.                          |

*Doubt first, then the reveal. That's what makes it feel real.*

HOOKS FOR

# SWITCHING & NEVER GOING BACK

*Compare the old way to the new one. The viewer sees themselves in the old way.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|     |                                                                                          |                                                                     |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 67. | <b>Why I'll never go back to <i>[old product]</i> after trying <i>[new product]</i>.</b> | Why I'll never go back to regular toothpaste after trying this one. |
| 68. | <b>Why I'm ditching <i>[common product]</i> for <i>[alternative]</i>.</b>                | Why I'm ditching paper planners for this app.                       |
| 69. | <b>Why I quit <i>[old habit]</i> and switched to <i>[product]</i>.</b>                   | Why I quit soda and switched to this sparkling tea.                 |
| 70. | <b><i>[Old way]</i> vs. <i>[product]</i>. It's not even close.</b>                       | Doing my taxes by hand vs. this app. It's not even close.           |
| 71. | <b>I replaced <i>[several things]</i> with one <i>[product]</i>.</b>                     | I replaced three skincare products with this one serum.             |
| 72. | <b>Why I'll never take <i>[old advice]</i> seriously again.</b>                          | Why I'll never take fad diets seriously again.                      |
| 73. | <b>Goodbye, <i>[old product]</i>. Hello, <i>[new product]</i>.</b>                       | Goodbye, paper receipts. Hello, this expense app.                   |
| 74. | <b>I switched to <i>[product]</i> for <i>[time]</i>. Here's what changed.</b>            | I switched to a standing desk for a month. Here's what changed.     |

*Name the old product they're still using. That's the hook.*

HOOKS FOR

# RECOMMENDATIONS

*Speak to one person with one problem, and hand them the fix.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|     |                                                                                       |                                                                              |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 75. | <b>This is why I swear by <i>[product]</i>.</b>                                       | This is why I swear by my silk pillowcase.                                   |
| 76. | <b>If you haven't tried <i>[product]</i>, you're missing out.</b>                     | If you haven't tried this herbal tea, you're missing out.                    |
| 77. | <b>You need <i>[product]</i> in your life if you struggle with <i>[problem]</i>.</b>  | You need this yoga mat in your life if you struggle to work out at home.     |
| 78. | <b>If you're struggling with <i>[problem]</i>, try this.</b>                          | If you're struggling with frizzy hair, try this anti-humidity spray.         |
| 79. | <b>If you're like me and <i>[trait]</i>, you'll love this.</b>                        | If you're like me and always forget to drink water, you'll love this bottle. |
| 80. | <b>Nothing is going to top this <i>[product]</i>.</b>                                 | Nothing is going to top this travel bag.                                     |
| 81. | <b>This is the blueprint for <i>[goal]</i>, and no one can convince me otherwise.</b> | This is the blueprint for meal prep, and no one can convince me otherwise.   |
| 82. | <b>Why I use <i>[product]</i> every single day.</b>                                   | Why I use this collagen supplement every single day.                         |
| 83. | <b>If you only buy one <i>[category]</i> this year, make it this.</b>                 | If you only buy one kitchen gadget this year, make it this.                  |

*The more specific the problem, the stronger the recommendation.*

HOOKS FOR

# HOW-TO & HACKS

*Teach something useful in seconds. Saves and shares come from value.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|     |                                                      |                                                                     |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 84. | This is how the pros use [product].                  | This is how the pros use this kitchen gadget to save time.          |
| 85. | Here's the secret to [result] with [product].        | Here's the secret to glowing skin with one product.                 |
| 86. | [#] hacks for [product] that changed everything.     | 5 hacks for this note-taking app that changed everything.           |
| 87. | If you want to get better at [activity], start here. | If you want to get better at strength training, start here.         |
| 88. | Here's how to [task] the right way.                  | Here's how to meal prep the right way.                              |
| 89. | What to do instead of [common approach].             | What to do instead of endless cardio.                               |
| 90. | Here's how to start from scratch with [product].     | Here's how to start from scratch with your home gym setup.          |
| 91. | Here's how you can save [money/time] with [product]. | Here's how you can save an hour a week with this meal prep service. |
| 92. | [#] steps to [result] with [product].                | 3 steps to a better skincare routine with one cleanser.             |
| 93. | Save this for the next time you [situation].         | Save this for the next time you pack for a trip.                    |

*Lead with the payoff, then show the steps.*

HOOKS FOR

# REVERSE PSYCHOLOGY

*Tell them it isn't for them. People hate being left out.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|      |                                                                                |                                                                    |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 94.  | <b>This is NOT for you if <i>[condition]</i>.</b>                              | This app is NOT for you if you like overspending.                  |
| 95.  | <b>Scroll past this unless you're <i>[target customer]</i>.</b>                | Scroll past this unless you're a busy mom who hates cooking.       |
| 96.  | <b>If you want to keep <i>[problem]</i>, keep scrolling.</b>                   | If you want to keep losing your keys, keep scrolling.              |
| 97.  | <b>Whatever you do, don't save this unless you want <i>[result]</i>.</b>       | Whatever you do, don't save this unless you want clear skin.       |
| 98.  | <b>If you don't want <i>[task]</i> to get easier, skip this.</b>               | If you don't want cleaning to get easier, skip this.               |
| 99.  | <b>You might not want to watch this if you love your <i>[old product]</i>.</b> | You might not want to watch this if you love your old phone case.  |
| 100. | <b>If you're already a <i>[expert]</i>, this isn't for you.</b>                | If you're already a makeup pro, this isn't for you.                |
| 101. | <b>Don't buy <i>[product]</i> unless you want <i>[result]</i>.</b>             | Don't buy this pillow unless you want to sleep through your alarm. |

*Exclude the wrong viewer, and the right one leans in.*

HOOKS FOR

# STRAIGHT TALK

*Say what others won't. Directness reads as honesty.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|      |                                                                               |                                                                                        |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 102. | I hate to be the one to tell you this, but <i>[truth]</i> .                   | I hate to be the one to tell you this, but your sunscreen isn't enough.                |
| 103. | I'm not going to sugarcoat it: <i>[truth]</i> .                               | I'm not going to sugarcoat it: your mattress is why you're tired.                      |
| 104. | Can someone explain why <i>[product]</i> isn't more popular?                  | Can someone explain why this app isn't more popular?                                   |
| 105. | You don't need <i>[expensive thing]</i> . What you need is <i>[product]</i> . | You don't need a gym membership. What you need is these resistance bands.              |
| 106. | This is going to sound harsh, but <i>[truth]</i> .                            | This is going to sound harsh, but your skincare routine is too long.                   |
| 107. | You said you wanted the honest truth about <i>[product]</i> , so...           | You said you wanted the honest truth about this viral blender, so...                   |
| 108. | I'm going to hurt my own feelings saying this, but <i>[truth]</i> .           | I'm going to hurt my own feelings saying this, but my \$80 moisturizer did nothing.    |
| 109. | The people who don't want to hear this need it the most: <i>[truth]</i> .     | The people who don't want to hear this need it the most: you don't need more products. |

*Be blunt about the problem, warm about the solution.*

HOOKS FOR

# MID-SENTENCE

*Start as if you're already mid-thought. The viewer feels like they caught something good.*

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

|      |                                                                                |                                                                           |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 110. | ...and the craziest part is <i>[surprising fact]</i> .                         | ...and the craziest part is it only took five minutes.                    |
| 111. | ...but what they don't tell you is <i>[hidden detail]</i> .                    | ...but what they don't tell you is the free version does all of this.     |
| 112. | ...and the part nobody talks about is <i>[detail]</i> .                        | ...and the part nobody talks about is how long it lasts.                  |
| 113. | ...and that's exactly the problem with <i>[old way]</i> .                      | ...and that's exactly the problem with drugstore primer.                  |
| 114. | ...and that's where you're wrong, because <i>[fact]</i> .                      | ...and that's where you're wrong, because this one's fragrance-free.      |
| 115. | So long story short, <i>[product]</i> <i>[result]</i> .                        | So long story short, this app paid for itself in a week.                  |
| 116. | Since we're already on the topic, this is exactly why I use <i>[product]</i> . | Since we're already on the topic, this is exactly why I use this planner. |
| 117. | ...but honestly, that's when everything changed.                               | ...but honestly, once I got this desk, that's when everything changed.    |

*No intro, no hello. Drop them straight into the best part.*

HOOKS FOR

# APPS & WEBSITES

*Made for Canvas and tech UGC. Show the screen, name the problem, let the app solve it.*

| THE HOOK |                                                                         | EXAMPLE                                                                        |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 118.     | POV: you finally found an app that <i>[solves problem]</i> .            | POV: you finally found an app that tracks every subscription you forgot about. |
| 119.     | The app I didn't know I needed until <i>[moment]</i> .                  | The app I didn't know I needed until tax season.                               |
| 120.     | Delete <i>[old app]</i> . Download <i>[new app]</i> . Thank me later.   | Delete your notes app. Download this one. Thank me later.                      |
| 121.     | This website does <i>[task]</i> in <i>[time]</i> , and it's free.       | This website builds your resume in five minutes, and it's free.                |
| 122.     | Apps that feel illegal to know about: <i>[app]</i> .                    | Apps that feel illegal to know about: this one finds you cheaper flights.      |
| 123.     | If your phone doesn't have <i>[app type]</i> , fix that today.          | If your phone doesn't have a budgeting app, fix that today.                    |
| 124.     | I can't believe <i>[app]</i> is free.                                   | I can't believe this photo editing app is free.                                |
| 125.     | <i>[#]</i> things this app does that your <i>[default app]</i> doesn't. | 3 things this calendar app does that your default calendar doesn't.            |
| 126.     | Me before <i>[app]</i> vs. me after <i>[app]</i> .                      | Me before this habit tracker vs. me after.                                     |
| 127.     | Stop scrolling. This app <i>[benefit]</i> .                             | Stop scrolling. This app turns your notes into flashcards.                     |
| 128.     | The <i>[app category]</i> app everyone's switching to right now.        | The budgeting app everyone's switching to right now.                           |

*Show the app working on screen within the first few seconds.*

YOUR NEXT STEP

# LET'S DO IT.

*When you're in need of a new hook and struggling with creative direction, come back here and try one for your Canvas or traditional videos.*

## SOLAE STUDIO ACADEMY

SOLAE STUDIO  
STUDIO SOLAE